**Listing 9.14 Fetching post-1970 movies using a `range` query**

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "range": {
      "release_date": {
        "gte": "01-01-1970"
      }
    }
  },
  "sort": [
    {
      "release_date": {
        "order": "asc"
      }
    }
  ]
}
```

The `release_date` field declares a `gte` operator with the search requirement: in this case, the year 1970. Notice that we also *sort* the movies in ascending order on the release date using the `sort` attribute in the query. The movies returned are therefore sorted from oldest to newest.

Because we are discussing `range` queries, let's use this opportunity to review date math in a `range` query. We discuss this in the following section.

### Data math in range queries

Elasticsearch supports sophisticated data math in queries. For example, we can ask the engine to perform tasks like these:

- Fetch book sales from two days ago (current day minus two days).
- Find access-denied errors in the last 10 minutes (current hour minus 10 minutes).
- Get tweets for particular search criteria from last year.

Elasticsearch expects a specific data expression that deals with data math. The first part of the expression is called an *anchor date*, followed by two vertical bars (`||`) indicating that the anchor date is being manipulated by adding or subtracting a certain number of time units (minutes, seconds, years, days, etc.) and then the time we want to add to or subtract from the anchor date.

Say we want to fetch movies released two days ago. We set the anchor date as today (at the time of writing, 22-05-2023) and subtract two days:

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "range": {
      "release_date": {
```